- All instance variables of the controller are also available in the template. This is how actions communicate data to the templates.

- The controller object's `flash`, `headers`, `logger`, `params`, `request`, `response`, and `session` are available as accessor methods in the view. Apart from the flash, view code probably shouldn't use these directly, because the responsibility for handling them should rest with the controller. However, we do find this useful when debugging. For example, the following `html.erb` template uses the `debug` method to display the contents of the session, the details of the parameters, and the current response:

```
<h4>Session</h4>  <%= debug(session) %>
<h4>Params</h4>   <%= debug(params) %>
<h4>Response</h4> <%= debug(response) %>
```

- The current controller object is accessible using the attribute named `controller`. This allows the template to call any public method in the controller (including the methods in `ActionController::Base`).

- The path to the base directory of the templates is stored in the attribute `base_path`.

What Goes in a Template

Out of the box, Rails supports two types of templates:

- ERB templates are a mixture of content and embedded Ruby. They're typically used to generate HTML pages.

- Jbuilder[160] templates generate JSON responses.

By far, the one that you'll be using the most will be ERB. In fact, you made extensive use of ERB templates in developing the Depot application.